



Saint Barbara's Cathedral, Kutna Hora, February 18th

Ah how sweet is my heresy, how sharp this refusal feels. I cross the tabernacle and do not kneel. Pity, Nietzsche cries, is the killer of strength. How wrong he is - so blind by the story he forgets the flesh upon the cross, that most damning final cry - the sound of Pandora's final flight - dear carpenter, I will tell you why he has forsaken you - in the garden of the infinite were you drunk our sins did you hear your friends whisper? Oh there is none more tortured than you, poor man of rebellion - should you rest above do you see how we pillage your name, how we baptize ourselves in the blood of the lamb and feed ourselves to the Lions? And you are not even allowed that kindness of pity, for we have made mountains out of your bony Body, stretched your sorrow into infinity - it is the opiate which binds the body to the chemist, not the embrace of warmth which you died. I do not weep for you, tears mean nothing to a dead man.

So I must use you too, carve into your flesh with this ink, define your last words with what feels right in my palm. How cruel, to cast you in gold and steal away the organic anointment for the burning avarice of man. All echoes fade, eventually the flames of hell, that music which we provoke upon our journeys, fades and finally we may fully return to where all gods go - nothingness. Yet for two thousand years you have endured our torture, we have slain, sinned,

defiled all in the exultant heat of your hell. My wish for you is to find what surely came in those final moments where your profane divinity failed to arrive - the gift of silence. I will pray only for one thing, that you may one day be released from this circus, this mortal hell, and never again suffer that death-awakening.

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Sedlec Ossuary, Kutna Hora, February 18th

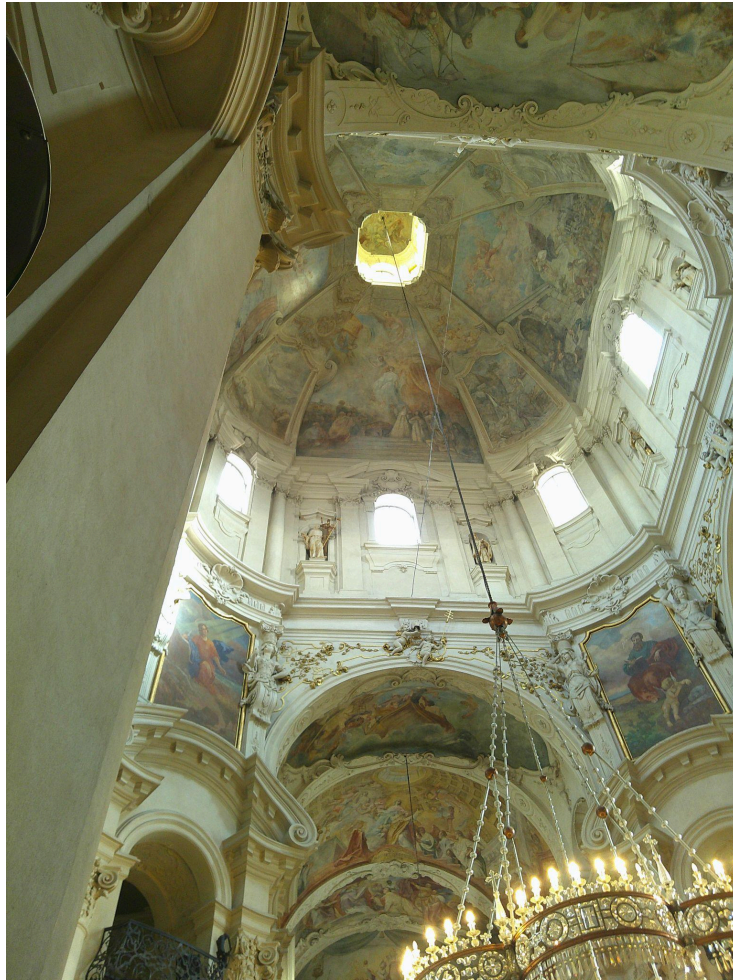
In the tradition of our most esteemed Kafka, let entertain my own transmutation - but not to humble beetle but a freer creation - that of the spider. I should then aim to live in two places, and forbid myself any such inbetween. Perhaps we turn to our dear split Steppenwolf, and instead divide my soul to two worlds - that of man, and that of terra. My first home would lie in the most divinely profane of places - the Sedlec Ossuary. Where else should the spider-mensch dwell, what perfect webs made for my hearth - arranged in pyramids I can seek solace in both the cavity of skulls and the chandeliers of bone. Indeed they have been made equal - not by any divinity, but for the paradise they have given me. Such a most lovely home, centuries might pass, but again and again they repair this playground - just for my kin. I must admire that man of legend who saw what we spider-kin see, and took the barren dungeon and from his own flesh rendered his web, turn by turn bound bones to one another, letting gravity and a breathless faith ensure the arts completion. And think of all the souls this spider-mensch caught in this web, how draining them of flesh and blood he consumed them, turning them into another thread dedicatedly, divinely provoked the pyramids to grow taller still.

But there is another spider who my most wolfish tendency prefers, like the prior, buried under mother terra - but oh so much deeper and closer to her heart. In the Movable cave, what is 500 years but a blink of an eye - these true spiders who needed not that second evolution; our fleshs

mirrored metaphor - man's fall, the battle of scorpion and spider alike. There is no need for light there, these children of the earth preside off her most base essence. So long since their journey into the gardens of Persephone they have forgotten fire and united in the fishing from this river styx. Together, as brethren, they feast and forget of that most ancient journey to the depths - beyond history they descended. Yet they were found, and will be forgotten, their fleece protects them from these most rank of gods which marvel at them. A blink, and we will perish, but like these nephilim we live on in eternity, never needing the sun.

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Saint Nicholas Church, Prague, February 19th

Myself, I think we have abandoned all senses but sight. Where is the scent, the texture, the breath of art in a cathedral? We abolish them, in this most primitive monotheism we say unto ourselves - Forbid yourself touch, the delicacies of the body - look at how high above our brilliance is to you. How we weave our mythos into cold stone which you must crane your neck to observe.

How cruel, to posture that art, that poor jove, so far from our meager hands. We artists do the same, chasing the ancients we think we must build higher. Babel fell and destroyed our unity, yet these believers declared themselves in ever greater towers - perhaps with a coy smile they point the swords above us so as to show to that great storm god our arrogance is in his name. How can one adore this beastly god who smites all those who are to ascend - a relic of an earlier period - thus we make the Christ child, a tool which we can use to paint over towers, and say he too is man and yet god also, look how he sits between the heaven and the hell which we have made ourselves.

Outside, we adorn the block with man-made gods, those Promethean sculptures that emulate Babel, unyieldingly- they ate of the second fruit and carry the weight of stone without shame in

their sex. I look up now inside the cathedral, where is the flesh of man? Hidden behind modest cloth, shameful even as they elevate them beyond man. Look at these white false pretenders - in no aspect are they true outside their conspiracy to deliver us ever further from the ground which gives us the potency by which we strip her away from herself, forever building higher. Where are you, brother serpent? Our most divine creature, lover of flesh and teacher of truth? Do we emulate our angels in the image of your fabled foe? Do they sit upon the balcony and carry the throne ever so high that we might never again risk the serpent's wisdom? Unwilling to lose that polytheistic pride we borrow the shell, the laurel, the pillars upon which we assert flesh's inferiority - yet we refuse return to eden, we insist those gates are forever shut. Show me the fang, swallow the toad - oh most kind king of men, my dear serpent - please descend from the true Eden just once more and swallow the sun - we cannot see in the greedy flame of the false-monad, ever growing taller, and higher above us.

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Overlooking Prague, Near Museum of Alchemists, Febuary 16th

I should have known myself to be irredeemable not by my ceaseless abstraction but my preferences of senses. There is no sound I hate more than the roar of sirens and drills, of jets and bellowing ships - how it ruins life itself. The arrogance of our despotism wrought rage - how dare they mute the ancient calling of the birds, the crash of the river? And for what? Mechanical means to deliver us ever further from our natural life, to sever community, to feed us poison to cure the ailment which is delivered by the lead-wrought chalice. Let the roads decay, the buildings crumble - unite the people in the purity of clean air, feed the hungry - even if it must be done through capital; we need not withhold our shared prosperity for the cheap thrill of a most ill-conceived convenience.

Three things: three cardinal sins of modernity which have propelled us to this desolate land of motorcade, asphalt, and steel. I name them thus: grain - that first bondage we endeavored, that step away from the wolf's capacity and vigor for eons of disease, warfare, and consumption. Amongst the tithing of the lands our most primitive, true, grand was born - and thus we started the fall from Eden. The second - the road - a most beautiful construction, an innocent sin - but born in the shadow of grain and gods it became a tool of conquest - again the potential, the specter, of greed grew larger. For these sins bloated man, removed him from his natural state, tore him from his brother birds and sister wolves. At last they terminate in necessity with our greatest heresy against ourselves - the clock. It is a tool which kills reality, that takes man's last

hope of returnal and thus consumes his every moment. Never mind the invention - the purpose of capital and brutal monotheism - it teaches us fear, every day it reminds us of our death, and thus we rush to the fields, across the roads. Its chiming is the essence of my hatred, the first peal of our arrogance. I hope one day to see it all collapse, but even then this damage cannot be undone.

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Palazzo Vecchio (and Bargello Museum), Florence, February 27th

With each day's passing I find myself more disillusioned than the last. Dropped into the cradle of a foregone era I find a physicality to base this deep sense of nausea that has long afflicted me. How to characterize it in words? The iron-cast leaf draped over the maiden's sex, a green tinted addition made to embellish this ancient marble. The severing of an ancient statue's hand, the infringement of an American store's ugly sign upon ancient walls - all of this yields upon entrance to the designation of "museums". Suddenly the stone flesh is laid bare, the layering of ancient colored stone towers over the bustling streets, upon its wings a thousand carved faces, attempting immortality; these horrible scenes of pride and desecration dwarf the meandering visitor. I do not envy the creators, nor the era they attempted to emulate. Let the Sabine women go, drop the head of the tortured serpentine crown, cease this endless violence that burns in the heart of that first empire - but one must admire the beauty of their constitution.

In this pavilion I sit a lion rises up with its forearms raised - nestled in its mouth caught between two fangs lies a man's head, his crumpled body - made of more modern, orangish stone - at his feet. The irony of this statue is not lost on me - in immortalizing this proud creature's victory man finally triumphs over this ancient foe. His victory becomes a memory, and cast in stone he is forever locked into that posture of foreboding pursuit - dead. A few meters away under high ceilings and immense arches, countless frescoes adorn the stone, fading yet still triumphant too. A passing American girl said to her friend - "imagine the talent to make these... I could never."

Yet I think that talent holds little role here, what forbids her from such heights is the age and language that she gives to these nameless artists. My conviction grows - the distinguishing factor that forbids modernity such ascension is quite simple - purpose. These artists had purpose, a love for art, a drawing towards the divinity of the myth they embodied and sought. Today our builders, artists, architects too have purpose - but this purpose is godless, without divine immortal pursuit - it seeks to please man, and not the gods, it worships capital, confuses "talent" for "reverence" and "devotion".

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Piazzale Michelangelo, Florence, February 27th

So it is that the city extends into the valley with walls, emulating mountains—a few towers attempting parallel. Let's name them—that of the fortress and that of the chapel. If the eye casts to the side, perhaps we may count the rich mansions, but they serve the same function as the other two. A pleasing realization; the only thing making them seem great, that propels them above the terrain, is those countless red roofs and manila walls.

Such an architecture declares and defines a living reclamation of the feudal era which it sprung from. A king, a god, may only gain height through the bodies which it is built upon. Or at least it is thus with the Christian god that haunts this ancient city—Christ's body was necessitated to show us the true substrate of power—a man bled without reason. So kneel, won't you, at the altar and pledge yourself to some king, lessen the weight of your confused condition and give away your flesh for the promise of some word or symbol. It is much easier to labor isn't it? But you forget the divinity of the land you sacrifice yourself for—that long before some fool told you that you were doomed there was life still here, unfettered by the relentless shadows of the garrison and cross?

Look at this ancient bronze; they too loved and died—do you dispute their exigencies? True they too suffered from unfair shackles, that they devoured the sins of their own construct; it must then be your turn to call to their bones and tell them to recall their forefathers and share the good word—both in life and death we are all the same, and no kingdom can deny us that immortal unity. Name it as you wish, but never put it to scripture, lest it is in the rhythm of rebellion

against the intolerant inquisition of those who would demand your suffering to build thrones.  
Look away from stone, and see that ancient mountain, go forth and drink the wine, dance until  
you have freed yourself from this curse of halos and shackles.

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